

Global warming

Carbon dioxide (CO₂) is a gas that traps heat and makes the Earth warmer. Peat stores large amounts of carbon (found in CO₂), so protecting boglands could help to slow global warming.

Peat contains as much carbon as is found in the air.

Plenty of plants

Peat bogs are habitats for rare plants such as sphagnum moss. These tiny plants look like a multi-coloured carpet because they grow so close together.

Hare's tail
cotton grass

Golden
plover

Sphagnum moss

Peat is formed over many thousands of years.

In the past, many people dried and burned peat to heat cooking stoves.

Emperor
dragonfly

Black soil

Peat is mostly made up of partly decomposed plants. This makes it black in colour. It feels soft and spongy to touch.